

Niki Bell ITLS 6250

The Frontier Model Showdown

1. The task. What were you trying to do?

Prompt:

Create a learning module. Draft a learning objectives set and a matching assessment plan for the graduate course, UX writing ITLS 6320.

We are trying to create a setup for the graduate class ITLS 6320 to help the students and teachers be able to visualize the organized modules and tests and understand how they work in this particular class.

2. Head-to-head performance. How did each model do on this task?

I said to create a learning module first, like the assignment mentioned, then specified that we wanted learning objectives set and an assessment plan, but I realized Ai may get confused and see those as the same task or different, but it plays an interesting role in this assignment to see how each interpreted it. I may change it when I do my tweaking. Gemini picked a specific topic in UX writing for its module: Strategic Microcopy and Cognitive Friction. I think it understood the prompt well, as a module is defined as a part of the entire course. It went really in-depth for the assessments and each part of the module, and the purpose they serve, and how they would be completed.

Claude did it completely differently. It created a whole interface similar to Canvas that started with a nicely organized title heading with the course and its description. It even created buttons for me to go to another “page” for objectives, assessment plan, OR alignment matrix. It focused more on visuals and organization over going into detail for the text explanations. All the subjects were pretty accurate. IT had 12 learning objectives and 7 assessments.

I also chose to use Grok as I have never before, and I was curious as to how it would perform, considering its unhinged behavior at times. It scared me at first as it directly cited Utah State to reference how its ITLS 6320 course is organized, and I had no idea how it knew I was attending USU. It knew nothing about me, being my first time using it. Then I realized in my prompt I specified the course name as well, not just the CRN, which varies among schools, and it was able to narrow it down, kind of crazy! Also interesting that the others weren’t able to do so. This AI also

created a setup for the entire course as expected. It was very accurate to the actual course I am taking, as it referenced the exact course through USU online. It listed my exact assessments.

3. Surprises. Where did a model do something you genuinely didn't expect — for better or worse?

I didn't expect Claude to create somewhat of an actual interface, it tried to create buttons and had cards for the objectives and assessments count. As well as cards for each module with their detailed captions inside.

I didn't expect Grok to reference my exact class at USU and its setup just from the class name.

4. Prompting observations. How did each model respond when you refined? Did one handle ambiguity better? Did one need more hand-holding?

I think Gemini is very dependent on every word and can't get context clues, so I had to hold its hand a little and specify exactly what we were looking for. It still gave me objectives that were very different from my actual course, but it set it up better, and eventually, I did want to see if it could match USU's course as well if I specifically told it to, and it was able to pretty well. Claude understood even with ambiguity and kept all the key principles from before, but simplified them into text when asked.

Grok was very fast and did well at understanding my simple adjustment without additional help. It wasn't good at creating it into an interface, though, but that isn't its strength.

5. Ethical and practical reflection. What concerns surfaced as you worked? How would you handle them in a real deployment of this work?

Naturally, I got concerned for my privacy initially when Grok knew what school I went to without telling it anything about me, but it was just smart in noticing key details.

That is still a little alarming since it can catch details about yourself without you even trying to inform them. Personally, I wouldn't use Grok in a professional setting as it is not filtered as much as most AI and can be more offensive, improper, and misleading. I wouldn't want it to accidentally include something in my course description that wasn't appropriate.

6. Your verdict. Based on this experience, when will you reach for each of these tools in your own practice? Be specific about kinds of tasks, not just model names.

For me personally, I plan to use Gemini on a more daily basis for small tasks as I have access to Pro being a student, and it is the multimodal monster. I feel like for my daily life, asking questions and including pictures for reference, Gemini is a great option. For example, asking about my house plants' health and how to best take care of them, planning my workouts, and creating a schedule, etc.

Anthropic is new to me, but I like it, and I think I will use it to help me draft my text when I need help writing a natural but professional email or text.

Grok is not my type of AI, and that is ok but I am happy to learn more about it. I think if I ever needed to reference pop culture or social media memes, etc. That is when I would use it, as It is a master of the current issues and not filtered as much as other models.